Gold, Migrants, and Rebellions

Around 1851, the European settlers began to discover gold in the country. This discovery attracted the attention of China and other countries in the world.

Back in the state of Victoria, the British government had imposed a license on those mining gold, which caused bloody rebellions in 1854 referred to as the Eureka Stockade. The government was victorious over the miners but they were given additional rights including voting rights and the ability to stand for parliament as long as they possessed a license. It is this point in time that is considered to be the origin of democracy in Australia.

Growth and Economy

The Aborigines had cultivated land and food for over 50,000 years before the Europeans arrived. The Europeanization of Australia involved exploration of the interior for minerals to help Australia establish better international relations through shipping, trade, and migration. Unexpected factors helped to shape a distinctive Australian continental experience, such as the sudden discovery of gold in the early 1850s and the subsequent rush of people to the goldfields in search of their fortunes. Land availability, assisted migration and the rise of a skilled workforce led to the growth of an expanding pastoral frontier in which bush life became embedded in Australian memory.

Urbanization also became a prime element of the Australian experience as colonial capital cities became the magnet for population. The growth of seaport cities as intermediaries for the exchange of Australia’s raw materials maintained strong connections between Australia and the wider world. There was often a conflict of interest between the need for extracting natural resources versus preserving the flora and fauna of the land. While these changes occurred, indigenous people struggled to cope with the ever changing landscape.

The Aborigines survived for centuries in Australia through a distinctive approach to gathering food and by utilizing a spiritual connection they had